ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Dependent prepositions

Use the prepositions selected by particular verbs, adjectives and nouns and recognise when the following form must be a gerund. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use dependent prepositions to build accurate lexical-grammatical patterns rather than translating prepositions directly while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Use the prepositions selected by particular verbs, adjectives and nouns and recognise when the following form must be a gerund.

MODEL

The team succeeded in reducing response times.

verb/adjective/noun + fixed preposition + noun or -ing

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main dependent prepositions patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses build accurate lexical-grammatical patterns rather than translating prepositions directly.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in professional writing, discussion, applications and everyday communication.

Build meaning before form

Use the prepositions selected by particular verbs, adjectives and nouns and recognise when the following form must be a gerund.

What dependent prepositions communicates

Use the prepositions selected by particular verbs, adjectives and nouns and recognise when the following form must be a gerund.

The central purpose is to build accurate lexical-grammatical patterns rather than translating prepositions directly. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The team succeeded in reducing response times.	a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition
She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.	an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition
There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.	a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: verb/adjective/noun + fixed preposition + noun or -ing. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “The team succeeded in reducing response times.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Verb pattern	verb + preposition + noun/-ing	The team succeeded in reducing response times.
Adjective pattern	adjective + preposition + noun/-ing	She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.
Noun pattern	noun + preposition + noun/-ing	There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition	Verb pattern
an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition	Adjective pattern
a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement	Noun pattern

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in professional writing, discussion, applications and everyday communication. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03
verb/adjective/noun	fixed preposition	noun or -ing

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: build accurate lexical-grammatical patterns rather than translating prepositions directly.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits professional writing, discussion, applications and everyday communication.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Verb pattern	verb + preposition + noun/-ing	The team succeeded in reducing response times.
Adjective pattern	adjective + preposition + noun/-ing	She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.
Noun pattern	noun + preposition + noun/-ing	There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The team succeeded in reducing response times.	a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition
She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.	an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition
There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.	a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not follow a preposition with a bare infinitive.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not translate the source-language preposition automatically.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not switch between in and of when the noun pattern fixes the relationship.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition?

OPTIONS The team succeeded in reducing response times. · She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices. · There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition?

OPTIONS She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices. · There has been a sharp increase in remote applications. · The team succeeded in reducing response times.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement?

OPTIONS There has been a sharp increase in remote applications. · The team succeeded in reducing response times. · She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The team succeeded in reducing response times.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition · an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition · a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition · a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement · a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement · a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition · an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"The team succeeded in reducing response times." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Verb pattern / Adjective pattern / Noun pattern · Gap 2: a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition / an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition / a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Adjective pattern / Noun pattern / Verb pattern · Gap 2: an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition / a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement / a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"There has been a sharp increase in remote applications." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Noun pattern / Verb pattern / Adjective pattern · Gap 2: a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement / a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition / an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition: _____. Choose the model that expresses an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition: _____. Choose the model that expresses a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement: _____. Choose the model built with verb + preposition + noun/-ing: _____. Choose the model built with adjective + preposition + noun/-ing: _____. Choose the model built with noun + preposition + noun/-ing: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices. · The team succeeded in reducing response times. · There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The team _____ response times. She is _____ the regional offices. There has been a sharp _____ remote applications. State the full structural pattern for Verb pattern: _____. State the full structural pattern for Adjective pattern: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The team successfully reduced response times.” using the Verb pattern pattern to express a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “Coordinating the regional offices is her responsibility.” using the Adjective pattern pattern to express an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Remote applications have increased sharply.” using the Noun pattern pattern to express a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The team successfully reduced response times.” using the Verb pattern pattern to express a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Verb pattern to express a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Adjective pattern to express an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Noun pattern to express a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The team succeeded in reducing response times.

Verb pattern is the best match because a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition.

A2

She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.

Adjective pattern is the best match because an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition.

A3

There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.

Noun pattern is the best match because a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement.

A4

a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition

The Verb pattern pattern communicates a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition.

A5

an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition

The Adjective pattern pattern communicates an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition.

A6

a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement

The Noun pattern pattern communicates a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Verb pattern / a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition

The structure belongs to the Verb pattern pattern. Its communicative purpose is a verb whose complement requires a fixed preposition.

B2

Adjective pattern / an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition

The structure belongs to the Adjective pattern pattern. Its communicative purpose is an adjective linked to its complement by a fixed preposition.

B3

Noun pattern / a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement

The structure belongs to the Noun pattern pattern. Its communicative purpose is a noun that selects a specific prepositional complement.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The team succeeded in reducing response times.

Verb pattern: verb + preposition + noun/-ing.

C2

She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.

Adjective pattern: adjective + preposition + noun/-ing.

C3

There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.

Noun pattern: noun + preposition + noun/-ing.

C4

The team succeeded in reducing response times.

Verb pattern: verb + preposition + noun/-ing.

C5

She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.

Adjective pattern: adjective + preposition + noun/-ing.

C6

There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.

Noun pattern: noun + preposition + noun/-ing.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

succeeded in reducing

Verb pattern requires “succeeded in reducing” in this model. verb + preposition + noun/-ing.

D2

responsible for coordinating

Adjective pattern requires “responsible for coordinating” in this model. adjective + preposition + noun/-ing.

D3

increase in

Noun pattern requires “increase in” in this model. noun + preposition + noun/-ing.

D4

verb + preposition + noun/-ing

Verb pattern is built as verb + preposition + noun/-ing.

D5

adjective + preposition + noun/-ing

Adjective pattern is built as adjective + preposition + noun/-ing.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The team succeeded in reducing response times.

verb + preposition + noun/-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended verb pattern effect.

E2

She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices.

adjective + preposition + noun/-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended adjective pattern effect.

E3

There has been a sharp increase in remote applications.

noun + preposition + noun/-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended noun pattern effect.

E4

The team succeeded in reducing response times.

verb + preposition + noun/-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended verb pattern effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The team succeeded in reducing response times. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses verb + preposition + noun/-ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

She is responsible for coordinating the regional offices. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses adjective + preposition + noun/-ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

There has been a sharp increase in remote applications. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses noun + preposition + noun/-ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____